INDIAN RAILWAY FINANCE CORPORATION
(A NAVRATNA CPSE UNDER MINISTRY OF RAILWAYS)

Future on Track



Inside IRFC's Transformation into a Diversified Infrastructure Financier



Manoj Kumar Dubey
Chairman & Managing Director and CEO
IRFC

Manoj Kumar Dubey, Chairman & Managing Director and CEO of Indian Railway Finance Corporation, on record FY26 profits, the IRFC 2.0 strategy, Navratna status, and steering India's railway financing arm into power, ports and renewable energy

Indian Railway Finance Corporation (IRFC), the dedicated market-borrowing arm of the Indian Railways under the Ministry of Railways, has just closed its strongest financial year yet. For the year ended 31st March 2026, IRFC posted a record profit after tax of Rs. 7,009.17 crore grew its assets under management to Rs. 4,84,616.77 crore and maintained a spotless zero-NPA record — all while undertaking the most significant strategic shift in its four-decade history. The growth story continues with all-time high Q1 results for FY 27. Under the leadership of Manoj Kumar Dubey, Chairman & Managing Director and CEO, IRFC is repositioning itself from a single-purpose railway financier into a diversified infrastructure financing institution — without losing sight of the Railways at its core. A 1994-batch Indian Railway Accounts Service officer and former Director (Finance) & CFO of CONCOR, Dubey took charge as CMD/IRFC in October 2024 and has since steered the company toward Navratna status and what he calls the "IRFC 2.0" era. In an exclusive conversation, he discusses the company's record-breaking year, its diversification strategy, and its road ahead:

Q: Mr. Dubey, FY 2025-26 has been described as a defining year for IRFC. Could you walk us through the key highlights of this year's performance?

A: FY26 has indeed been a defining year for IRFC. We closed the year with our highest-ever profit after tax of Rs. 7,009.17 crore, up 7.80% over the previous year, on a revenue from operations of Rs. 27,284.15 crore. Our assets under management crossed an all-time high of Rs. 4,84,616.77 crore, and our net worth rose to Rs. 56,748.76 crore. What I find most satisfying is that this growth has come alongside continued discipline: a NIL Gross NPA position, and a capital adequacy ratio of 110.91%, among the highest in the NBFC space. Our net interest margin improved to 1.50% on an annualised basis, up from 1.42% the previous year, reflecting the early impact of our diversification strategy. We have built a diversified infrastructure financing portfolio while remaining firmly aligned to our core mandate of supporting the railway ecosystem.

Q: IRFC has long been synonymous with railway financing. You have spoken about 'IRFC 2.0' as a structural shift in the company's business model. What exactly does this transformation involve, and why was it necessary?

A: For nearly four decades, IRFC's business model was straightforward — we raised money from domestic and international markets and financed